Eisenhower was being inducted as university president. Eventually he received a telephone extension number that was exactly like mine but for an inversion of numerals.

Thinking of the troubles we had with the inversion of our home telephone number, I kept expecting to get calls intended for Eisenhower. I even had daydreams of having someone call me and say, "Hello, Ike?" (I'd know it wasn't for me, but for Eisenhower, who affected that irrelevant nickname, while I allow very few people to call me that.) I would then lean back and say, cozily, "Yes?" and see what happened. However, no one ever made the mistake.

After Eisenhower had been in office a couple of months, he sent out a form letter to all the alumni. I was an alumnus so I received one. On impulse, I replied to him. Before too long I received a two-paragraph letter from him, dated February 11, 1949, which was polite and personal (it quoted a passage from my letter, so it had to be a direct answer) and which was, as nearly as I can tell, signed by him in person.

It was even better than the letter from Orson Welles, and I still own it.

I did not attend any of the ceremonies on October 12, however, but seized the chance of getting out to Elizabeth, New Jersey, where Campbell was now located, in order to see him. I had completed "Mother Earth" two days before, doing its fifteen thousand words in just under six weeks, and I wanted to submit it to him. (After asking

for a small change in the end, the next day, he took it, and the story earned me $375.)

Campbell was more interested in the Foundation series, however. He had been sending me several letters while I was working on "Mother Earth," asking me to finish it and start another Foundation tale. During our session on the twelfth, we discussed my idea on this and I finally persuaded him to let me reveal the whereabouts of the Second Foundation. He did so on condition I make the story fifty thousand words long so that he could run it as a serial. (I suppose he suspected, from my attitude, that the new story would be the last of the Foundation series, and he wanted to end it on a high note.) I agreed to call it "—And Now You Don't" to tie in with the title of the previous Foundation story, which I had completed i24 years before.

I began "—And Now You Don't" on October 16, and from the very start I knew I would have trouble.